

25 Speaking a foreign language

25.1 USEFUL EXPRESSIONS

I speak **conversational** German, but my grammar is awful.

conversational

[language that is not technically perfect, but clear enough for basic communication]



My uncle is **fluent in** five different languages.

fluent in

[able to use a language easily, without making many mistakes]



I was taught French by a **native speaker** from Marseilles.

a native speaker

[a person who speaks a language as their first language]



My wife is **bilingual**; she speaks English and Japanese.

bilingual

[able to speak two languages fluently]



Zara's Portuguese is a bit **rusty**. She hasn't spoken it in years.

rusty

[not as fluent in a language as you used to be]



Maria's strong **accent** is impossible to understand.

an accent

[the way in which people from a country or region pronounce a word]



Juan finds the **pronunciation** of the word "squirrel" impossible.

pronunciation

[the way a specific word is spoken]



Dan's spoken Mandarin isn't bad, but he needs to improve his **grammar**.

grammar

[the way in which you make sentences from separate words]



I bought a dictionary to improve my Spanish **vocabulary**.

vocabulary

[the set of words that make up a language]



Watching French TV helps you improve your **listening** skills.

listening

[the ability to understand spoken language]

